

Fix the portfolio's efficiency. Use the festival as the engine.

My first month as Music Creator Manager · Belle He · August 2026

1 · COACH BY ARCHETYPE

The portfolio's problem is **efficiency, not effort**: the most active creators are declining. Two failure patterns, two coaching plans.

2 · FESTIVAL AS ENGINE, NOT EVENT

A "Road to Pulse" **competition** recruits new music creators and gives existing ones the discovery they are starved of; one mechanic, two funnels.

3 · SUPPLY-FIRST METRICS

Revenue follows retention and discovery. **Leading indicators gate every dollar** of the \$80K budget, with a go/no-go checkpoint at week 4.

PORTFOLIO DIAGNOSIS

The most active creators are declining: an efficiency problem, not an effort problem

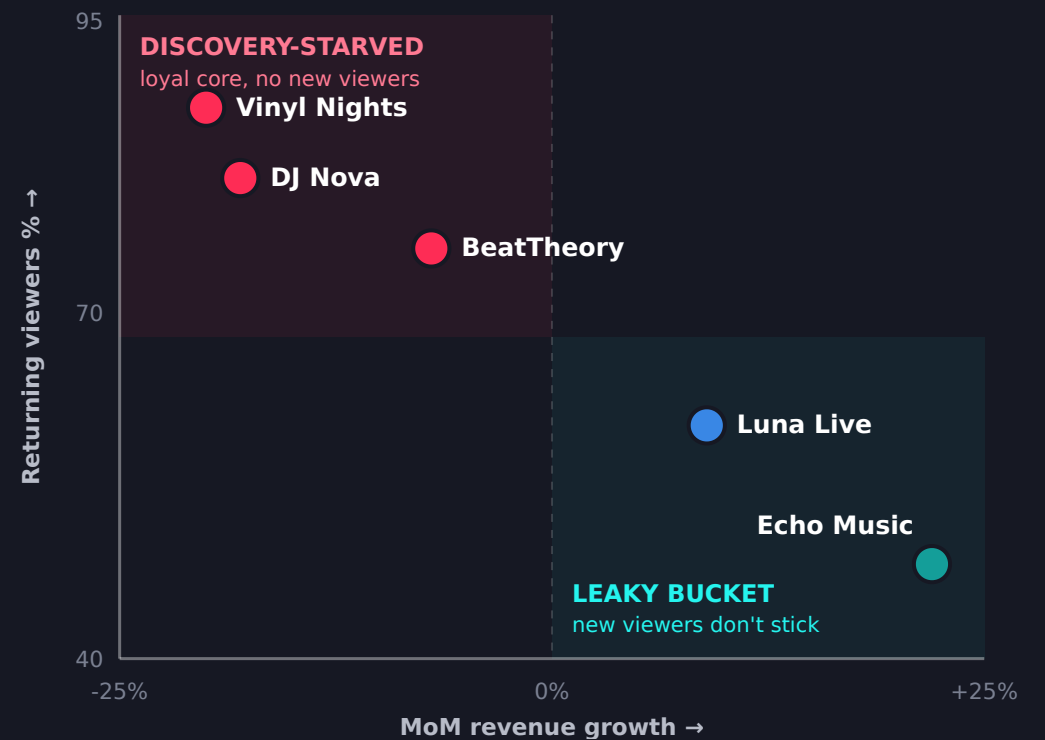
Last 30 days. Revenue per LIVE hour spans 5× across the portfolio.

CREATOR	LIVE HRS	AVG CCV	REVENUE	REV / HR	MOM	RETURNING
Echo Music	38	1,250	\$12,100	\$318	+22%	48%
Luna Live	58	910	\$17,600	\$303	+9%	60%
DJ Nova	115	430	\$14,200	\$123	-18%	81%
BeatTheory	90	310	\$10,400	\$116	-7%	75%
Vinyl Nights	126	185	\$7,800	\$62	-20%	87%

Hours and growth are **inversely related**: the two creators streaming the most (126h, 115h) are declining fastest. The portfolio needs **better hours, not more hours**. Portfolio-level: **\$62.1K** total, weighted MoM **-3.4%**; Luna + Echo generate **48% of revenue on 23% of the hours**.

Note: MoM values 0.09 and 0.22 in the source table are read as +9% and +22%.

RETURNING VIEWERS VS. REVENUE GROWTH (MOM)



87% returning viewers with -20% revenue isn't loyalty. It's a ceiling.

Grow two, fix two, sustain one: prioritized by where coaching changes the trajectory

Each archetype gets a different playbook. Coaching effort is a scarce resource; it goes where it bends the curve.

GROW

Echo Music (first priority): momentum is perishable. Fixed schedule, fan club & subscriptions push, welcome rituals, convert surge viewers into followers.

Luna Live: codify her playbook for the whole portfolio; scale hours gently (58 → ~75).

FIX

Vinyl Nights: fewer, better hours (126 → ~80); format refresh; co-host slots with rising creators.

DJ Nova: content refresh, off-peak experiments, festival-stage exposure as a new-audience injection.

SUSTAIN

BeatTheory: prevention, not rescue. Runs Luna's codified playbook, one new-format experiment per month; alert if returning % keeps rising while growth falls (early discovery-starved pattern).

OPTIONS CONSIDERED: Coaching all five equally: rejected. Echo comes first because momentum decays fastest; a surge unconverted this month is gone next month.

Festival roles are part of the fix: Echo & Luna showcase on the LIVE stage · Nova gets a stage slot as a new-audience injection · Vinyl co-hosts the semifinal events · BeatTheory mentors the bootcamp.

ADDITIONAL DATA I WOULD REQUEST

- Traffic source split: For You feed vs. followers (separates the two archetypes cleanly)
- New vs. returning viewers in absolute counts, and viewer → follower conversion
- Gifting concentration: how much revenue depends on top gifters
- Subscription penetration, time-slot performance, 90-day trend (30 days can mislead)

HOW I MEASURE SUCCESS

- **Portfolio revenue per LIVE hour:** the efficiency north star
- New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl (discovery fix working)
- Returning-viewer rate ↑ for Echo (retention fix working)
- Portfolio MoM revenue positive within 60 days (lagging validation)

One festival, three funnels: recruit the new, energize the existing, showcase the top

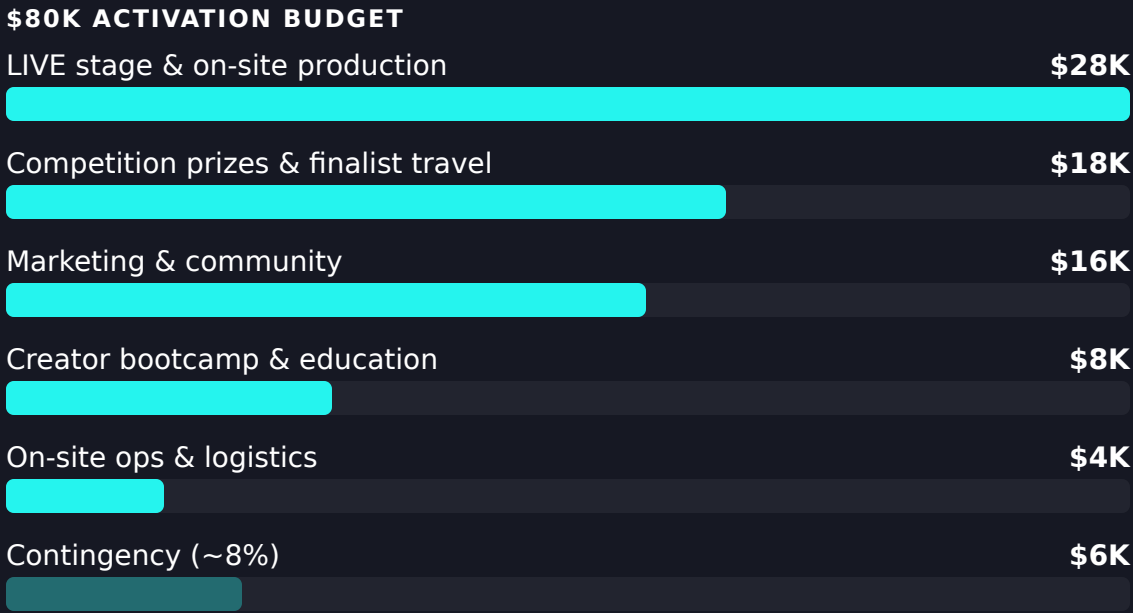
Excitement isn't a separate workstream; it's the output of the other three, clipped and amplified.

RECRUIT · the Rising division of "Road to Pulse": a dedicated on-ramp for musicians who have never gone LIVE

ENERGIZE · existing creators compete in the Headliner division; 4-week bootcamp + archetype coaching

SHOWCASE · TikTok LIVE stage at Pulse: finals + top-talent performances, all streamed

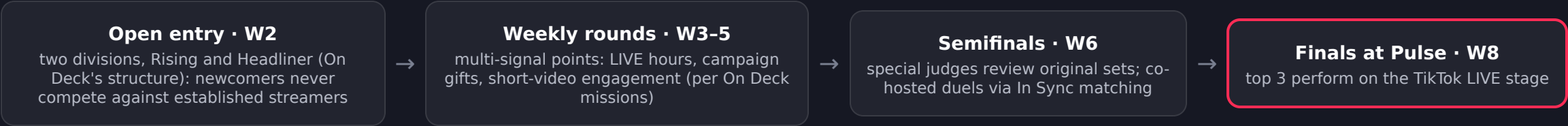
OPTIONS CONSIDERED: *Spreading budget evenly across five workstreams: rejected. Stage + competition compound each other; marketing amplifies a story the competition creates for free.*



Assumption: platform traffic and product support are in-kind and outside this cash budget.

"Road to Pulse", modeled on On Deck: Breakaway, with the entry gate the official campaigns don't have

Proven architecture, deliberately copied. My changes target what On Deck leaves open: recruiting pre-LIVE musicians, and day-31 aftercare.



THE REWARD LADDER (ON DECK'S DESIGN: CAREER CAPITAL OVER CASH)

WHO	REWARD	COST
All entrants	Pulse avatar frame + campaign badge	≈ \$0, platform asset
Round winners	Diamonds + festival merch	low
Semifinalists	VIP Pulse tickets, travel covered	the bulk of \$18K
Top 3	Stage slot + distribution support (as in Music On Stage) + own track released as a limited-run LIVE Gift (as in Songs of LIVE)	≈ \$0, priceless

Even On Deck's cash-equivalent prizes are modest: the top of the ladder isn't bought, it's platform access. That's why \$18K is enough.

INSIDE EVERY ENTRANT'S ROOM (ON DECK'S PRODUCTION MECHANICS)

- Campaign-exclusive **Pulse Gift** with in-room counter
- **Milestone progress bar**: gift-point thresholds unlock the next reward tier
- **Live rank badge** shown in the room; leaderboard resets weekly
- **Shout-out segment**: entrants thank top supporters on air, a built-in retention ritual

I watched these mechanics run live in On Deck rooms; they double as coaching material for the portfolio.

Runs alongside: education and the pipeline. A 4-week bootcamp covers streaming craft and the 1K → Gifts → Subscriptions → Rewards ladder, with portfolio creators as mentors. After the festival, every entrant enters a 30-day incubation track (first LIVE within 2 weeks, 3 streams/week by day 30). The festival is a pipeline, not a finish line. And On Deck itself runs different missions per tier; the platform already coaches by archetype, and I apply the same logic inside the portfolio.

On site, the festival is both a stage and a content factory

Three days of festival → eight weeks of content and three partner relationships that outlive the event.

ON-SITE ACTIVATIONS

- **TikTok LIVE stage:** competition finals + portfolio top-talent showcases, all streamed to the platform
- **Backstage co-streams** with festival artists (cleared in advance with labels)
- **Discovery booth:** attendees start their first LIVE on-site with staff guidance; recruitment made physical
- **QR attribution:** stage and booth QR codes deep-link to each creator's LIVE, so festival impact is measurable per creator

MARKETING & COMMUNITY

- Co-branded hashtag challenge with Pulse, seeded by competition entrants
- Weekly competition highlights clipped to short-form; short-form reach feeds LIVE viewership
- Entrant community spaces: peer support now, retention channel after the festival

EXTERNAL PARTNER MANAGEMENT

- **Festival org:** deliverables SLA + weekly sync; stage specs locked by week 6
- **Agencies / Creator Networks:** recruitment channels with entry targets per partner
- **Labels & artists:** co-stream clearances start week 1: licensing lead time is the long pole

PROJECT PLAN

Eight weeks, five milestones, one weekly heartbeat



◆ W1 creator 1:1s, metrics locked, rights inventory + licensing started ◆ W2 competition live ◆ W4 entries go/no-go checkpoint ◆ W6 logistics & finalists locked
◆ W8 festival ◆ W+4 retention report

BIGGEST RISKS → MITIGATIONS

Low competition entries	Agency pre-commitments; W4 checkpoint triggers paid boost from contingency
On-site tech failure	Redundant streaming setup + full rehearsal in W7
Gift-vote gaming	Judge-score gate + anomaly monitoring on voting patterns
Partner deliverables slip	SLA with weekly sync; stage specs frozen at W6
Budget overrun	8% contingency + weekly burn review
On-site content / brand safety	Dedicated moderation coverage for all festival streams; escalation path agreed with Trust & Safety in advance

STAKEHOLDERS

Internal: Product, Data Science, Marketing, Legal & Music Licensing, Event Ops
External: Pulse festival org, agencies / Creator Networks, labels & artists

KEEPING IT ON TRACK

Weekly standup · one owner per workstream · live dashboard on entries, coaching metrics, and budget burn

SUCCESS METRICS

Measure supply first: revenue follows

Targets below are illustrative; week 1 locks them against baseline data.

LAYER	METRIC	ILLUSTRATIVE TARGET
Leading · supply	Competition entries · first-time LIVE creators · portfolio quality-weighted hours · bootcamp completion	500+ entries; 150+ first LIVEs; completion ≥ 60%
Process · engagement	Music-vertical watch time during campaign · portfolio new-viewer share · average concurrent viewers	New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl; ACV ↑ portfolio-wide
Lagging · revenue & health	Portfolio revenue MoM · revenue per LIVE hour · D30 retention of newly recruited creators	MoM positive by W8; rev/hr ↑; D30 retention ≥ 40%

Supply and retention are the cause; revenue is the effect. I act on leading metrics and am judged by lagging ones.

WHAT LEADERSHIP SEES AT DAY 30

Diagnosis done, archetype coaching live

Competition running, entries vs. target at W4 gate

Festival logistics on track, licensing under way

Metrics dashboard live, leading indicators trending

Recommendation: approve this plan, subject to week 1 validation of baseline data, the rights inventory, and partner deliverables.